

STIHL SHOP DEALER WEBSITE PLATFORM

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)

Version:

Version 1.0

Issued By:

STIHL New Zealand

Issue Date:

4 September 2026

KEY DATES

Activity	Date
RFP Released	4 September 2026
Vendor Confirmation of Participation	11 September 2026
Vendor Questions Due	18 September 2026
STIHL SHOP Response to Questions	25 September 2026
Vendor Proposal Submission	9 October 2026
Shortlist Selection	16 October 2026
Vendor Presentations	22-23 October 2026
Preferred Vendor Selected	30 October 2026
Contract Finalisation	13 November 2026
Pilot Store Deployment	December 2026
Network Rollout Commences	January 2027

1. INTRODUCTION

STIHL SHOP is New Zealand's leading specialist retailer of outdoor power equipment, represented by a nationwide network of independently owned and operated dealerships.

STIHL SHOP operates the national eCommerce platform stihlshop.co.nz, which is the authorised online destination for STIHL product sales in New Zealand.

Customers selecting products through the platform nominate their preferred STIHL SHOP dealer, with transactions attributed directly to that dealer. STIHL Head Office does not transact directly with end consumers.

In addition, selected preferred supplier products are sold through the STIHL SHOP eCommerce platform.

STIHL SHOP seeks proposals from experienced digital agencies and platform providers capable of delivering a managed dealer website framework aligned to the national STIHL SHOP digital strategy.

Individual stores maintain their own websites to promote their local business, highlight their unique workshop expertise, and showcase products or services that are specific to their location and not commonly offered across the wider dealer network. These websites serve primarily as local marketing and information platforms, helping stores build awareness within their communities and communicate their specialised capabilities. They are not intended to function as e-commerce sites, and online transactions, order processing, and centralised product sales are managed through the national STIHL SHOP website rather than through individual dealer websites.

2. PROJECT BACKGROUND

Dealer websites currently vary significantly across the network.

Differences exist in:

- Website quality
- User experience
- Brand compliance
- Mobile optimisation
- Search engine performance
- Content consistency
- Promotion management
- Technical support

This inconsistency creates customer confusion and reduces the effectiveness of the STIHL SHOP brand online.

The purpose of this initiative is to establish a consistent national framework while allowing dealers some flexibility to personalise their local presence.

3. PROJECT OBJECTIVES

The successful vendor will assist STIHL SHOP to:

Brand Consistency

Maintain a common STIHL SHOP look and feel across all dealer websites.

Customer Experience

Deliver a premium digital experience consistent with stihlshop.co.nz.

Dealer Flexibility

Allow dealers to personalise approved content areas.

Governance

Provide central control of standards and brand compliance.

Reduced Administration

Minimise website management requirements for dealers.

Performance

Improve SEO, visibility, website speed and customer engagement.

4. CURRENT DIGITAL ENVIRONMENT

STIHL SHOP maintains:

National website:

www.stihlshop.co.nz

The national website:

- Sells STIHL products.
- Sells selected preferred supplier products.
- Attributes sales to dealers.
- Provides national promotions.
- Maintains product data and pricing.
- Provides a consistent customer buying experience.

Dealer Websites

For those that choose to have a website, dealers maintain local websites which:

- Promote their business.
- Provide workshop information.
- Promote local events.
- Display approved supplier products.
- Provide contact information.
- Promote local expertise.

The successful solution must complement the national website rather than compete with it.

5. WEBSITE GOVERNANCE MODEL

National Ownership

STIHL SHOP will retain ownership of:

- Brand standards
- Website structure
- Templates
- Navigation standards
- STIHL product presentation
- Digital compliance requirements
- Approved supplier standards

Dealer Ownership

Dealers may maintain:

- Store information
- Team profiles
- Service capabilities
- Community involvement
- Local promotions
- Approved supplier content

All local content must comply with STIHL SHOP standards.

6. STIHL PRODUCT RULES

Dealer websites may display STIHL products; however, any STIHL product information, specifications, imagery, pricing, and promotional content must be maintained accurately and kept current at all times.

To minimise ongoing maintenance and ensure consistency of product information, STIHL recommends that dealer websites direct customers to www.stihlshop.co.nz at a category or product level rather than maintaining a local STIHL product catalogue.

Dealer websites must not facilitate the direct online sale or transaction of STIHL products.

Where a customer:

- Selects a STIHL product;
- Clicks a "Buy Now" or similar call-to-action;
- Views a STIHL product detail page; or
- Commences a purchase journey relating to a STIHL product,

the customer must be redirected to the relevant product page within www.stihlshop.co.nz.

All STIHL product transactions must be completed through the STIHL SHOP eCommerce platform.

7. SUPPLIER GOVERNANCE

Dealers may promote and sell non-STIHL products and services relevant to their business. The supplier's governance framework must accommodate dealer-specific product ranges while ensuring overall website quality, legal compliance, and adherence to STIHL SHOP branding guidelines.

8. WEBSITE REQUIREMENTS

The platform should provide:

- Mobile-first design
- Fast page loading
- Secure cloud hosting
- Local content capability
- Contact forms
- Interactive maps
- Store information
- Staff profiles
- Promotion management
- Event management
- Analytics reporting

9. CONTENT MANAGEMENT

The preferred vendor should provide a managed content service designed to minimise the time dealers spend maintaining their websites.

The supplier should be responsible for:

- Website content updates, including national promotions and campaigns
- Seasonal campaign deployment across all dealer websites
- Image and digital asset management
- Promotional content updates
- SEO optimisation and ongoing performance improvements
- Brand compliance monitoring and reporting
- Network-wide content updates and maintenance where changes apply across multiple or all dealer websites

Dealers should have access to a secure content management portal enabling them to make approved local updates, including:

- Store-specific product ranges and availability
- Local promotions and events
- Store information, trading hours and contact details
- Staff profiles and localised content
- Community sponsorships and other dealer-specific content

The supplier should provide appropriate user permissions, training and support to ensure dealers can make local updates while maintaining brand standards and website integrity.

10. DESIGN REQUIREMENTS

Dealer websites should reflect:

- STIHL SHOP retail positioning
- National design standards
- Premium customer experience
- Consistent navigation
- Consistent visual hierarchy
- Consistent product presentation

The design should feel like an extension of the national website.

11. SEO & ANALYTICS

The successful vendor must demonstrate:

- Local SEO capability
- Technical SEO expertise
- Reporting dashboards
- Keyword monitoring
- Traffic reporting
- Conversion reporting

Dealer-level analytics and network-level analytics are required.

12. HOSTING & SECURITY

The solution must include:

- Cloud hosting
- SSL certificates
- Daily backups
- Security monitoring
- Uptime monitoring
- Disaster recovery capability

Minimum availability target:

99.9% uptime

13. SUPPORT REQUIREMENTS

Vendors must outline:

- Service desk model
- Escalation process
- SLA commitments
- Content update turnarounds
- Emergency support process

Preferred support:

Priority	Response Time
Critical	2 Hours
High	4 Hours
Medium	1 Business Day
Low	3 Business Days

14. IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

Vendors should provide:

Phase 1 – Discovery and platform design

Phase 2 – Pilot deployment

Phase 3 – Dealer onboarding

Phase 4 – Network rollout

Phase 5 – Ongoing optimisation and support

15. VENDOR RESPONSE REQUIREMENTS

Responses should include:

- Company overview
- Team structure
- Relevant experience
- Multi-site retail experience
- Franchise experience
- Proposed solution
- Hosting model
- Support model
- Project timeline
- Pricing

16. EVALUATION CRITERIA

Criteria	Weighting
Digital Strategy Alignment	20%
Design & Customer Experience	20%
Governance & Compliance	20%
Support Model	15%
Technical Capability	15%
Cost & Commercials	10%

17. COMMERCIAL RESPONSE

Vendors must separately identify:

- Setup fees
- Website migration fees
- Monthly fees
- Hosting fees
- Content management costs
- Optional services

18. LEGAL REQUIREMENTS

STIHL SHOP will retain ownership of:

- Branding
- Customer data
- Dealer content
- Digital assets

The successful vendor must comply with:

- New Zealand Privacy Act
- Fair Trading Act
- Consumer Guarantees Act
- Applicable cybersecurity standards

19. DESIRED OUTCOME

The preferred solution will provide a nationally consistent, professionally managed dealer website ecosystem that:

- Strengthens the STIHL SHOP brand.
- Complements stihlshop.co.nz.
- Provides dealers with local flexibility.
- Delivers a superior customer experience.
- Requires minimal dealer administration.
- Supports future growth of both STIHL and approved supplier brands.